own terms that was not acceptable (Dunya TV News bulletin, 2012). On the other hand, TTP scoffed at repeated government offers of truce or surrender, which showed their arrogance, will to fight and confidence in their strength. In November 2012, after the terrorist acts of sectarian violence in Karachi, Peshawar, Rawalpindi and Dera, Ismail Khan, the interior minister of Pakistan, during the first seven days of the Islamic month of Muharram, offered a truce to TTP. The TTP rejected it and vowed to continue fighting until the ousting of the country's 'secular rulers' (*The News International*, 2012).

- These strategic flaws were repeated time and again.
- Tenacity: The second cardinal element of STOP formula was to assess the determination of the insurgents/terrorists to utilise their strength, pursue their objectives and fight back resiliently. All indicators pointed that TTP had shown enough tenacity to fight back despite substantial damage to its command and control structure in South Waziristan. They kept bouncing back not only in the Waziristan area, but also carried out terrorist acts in urban centres of Pakistan. Earlier on, Maulvi Fazlullah and Maulvi Faqir were ousted from their areas of jurisdiction and their command and control structures were completely destroyed, but after some time, they started retaliating. They used 'strategic depth' and fought back from their hideouts in Kunar and Nuristan provinces of Afghanistan. They carried out organised attacks inside Pakistan.
- Objectives: In response to the repeated government offers of negotiations and amnesty to the TTP, they had been making several demands, including the release of fighters from prisons. Maulvi Faqir Muhammad, TTP's deputy commander and commander in Bajaur Agency, said that 'The TTP welcomes the prime minister's offer' and set two preconditions for the dialogue: to reconsider the government's relationship with the US and to enforce Islamic *Sharia* in the country. 'We never wanted to fight to begin with,' said the senior Taliban commander. 'Our aim was to rid Afghanistan of foreign forces. But the Pakistani government, by supporting America, left us no choice but to fight.'
- Maulvi Faqir and other senior TTP cadres were believed to be hiding in the eastern Afghan provinces of Kunar and Nuristan. Islamabad blamed militants led by Maulvi Faqir for the cross-border attacks on its security forces.